
ORCID: [0000-0001-8043-9897](https://orcid.org/0000-0001-8043-9897)**Web:** [LinkedIn](#)

PROFILE – interdisciplinary biologist with focus on conservation of large carnivores

I am a researcher at the intersection of genetics, phenotype, and the consequences of human interventions on wild animals. I specialize in large carnivore population genetics, phenotype, and ecological adaptations. As a member of IUCN Canid specialist group, I work on the assessment of *Canis lupus* subspecies, drawing upon my knowledge. During my PhD I established three different projects and including two based on new global cooperations. I am skilled in project management, teaching, and science communication, with several first author publications in high-impact journals. As part of science communication, I developed a board game called the Lone Wolf, to educate public about wolves and their importance while conducting socio-ecological research on children's opinions about large carnivores.

SKILLS

- Study design, management, and implementation for global genetic (>450 samples) and morphological studies (>220 samples)
- 3D and CT scanning, 3D geometric morphometrics, comparative and functional morphology of wolves globally
- Statistical analysis and data visualization in R
- Population genetics laboratory and analytical techniques, analysis of genetic diversity, population structure, and connectivity
- Comparative studies of wolf morphology to investigate ecological adaptation and human impacts
- Wolf and wolverine ecology
- Planning and leading large international collaborative research projects (~20 collaborators)
- Research on human–nature relationships
- Science communication and public engagement, nature-based education, youth engagement, outreach
- Development of educational and science communication tools (e.g., *Lone Wolf* board game, research exhibition)
- Integration of morphological, genetic, and ecological data in evolutionary and conservation research

DEGREES

Doctoral Degree Program in Biology, University of Oulu, Finland	01/01/20 – 11/05/26
Topic: Genetic and morphological consequences of isolation, habitat, and humans for wolverines and wolves. Graduated with distinction.	
Master of Science in Ecology and Population Genetics, University of Oulu, Finland	01/01/18 – 31/12/19
Dissertation project: Demographic history and phylogeography of Eurasian Wolverines (<i>Gulo gulo</i>).	
Bachelor of Science with Honours, Biological Sciences, Ecology, The University of Edinburgh, Scotland, UK	16/09/13 – 26/05/17
Dissertation project: Investigation of spatial cognition in amphibians.	

OTHER EDUCATION AND EXPERTISE

Geometric Morphometrics Workshop (Advanced), Geomorph, Barcelona	08/05/23 – 12/05/23
Pedagogical training - Basics of University Pedagogy, University of Oulu	06/10/22 – 03/11/22
Geometric Morphometrics Workshop (Basics), Physalia Courses, online	04/04/22 – 08/04/22
Masterclass Academic Writing, Huizingh Academic Development	19/09/22 – 20/09/22
Presentation skills, Niina Sainius	2021

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Slovak: Native; English: Proficient user (C2); Russian: Upper-Intermediate user (B2); Finnish: Learning (A1)

CURRENT EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral research fellow, Functional morphology, University of Antwerp	15/07/26 – 14/07/27
---	---------------------

PREVIOUS WORK EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Degree Program in Biology:

Grant by Suomen Kulttuurirahasto + 10% contract with University of Oulu	01/09/25 – 28/02/26
Grant by Vilho, Yrjö ja Kalle Väisälän rahasto + 10% contract with University of Oulu	01/09/24 – 31/08/25
Employed by University of Oulu	01/03/24 – 31/08/24
Grant by the University of Oulu Scholarship Foundation	01/01/24 – 29/02/24
Intern in the Population Genetics Laboratory , University of Ostrava, Czech Republic	01/01/19 – 01/04/19
Intern in Nature Protection within the National Park , State Nature Conservancy SR	01/11/18 – 31/12/18
Research work in the laboratory , University of Oulu, Finland	01/04/18 – 30/11/18
Research work in the field - Bird ringing, University of Oulu, Finland	01/10/17 – 15/12/17
Intern in Forest Engineering , Universität für Bodenkultur Wien, Austria,	01/07/17 – 12/08/17
Bat Surveyor , David Dodds Associates - Consultant Ecologist	01/05/17 – 24/06/17
Assistant Teacher at the Field Course , The University of Edinburgh	31/05/17 – 06/06/17
Zoological Research Expedition Member in Trinidad , Glasgow Expedition Society	31/05/16 – 12/08/16

RESEARCH FUNDING AND GRANTS

I secured over €67,000 in competitive funding through research grants, working grants, and support for international research visits and conference participation. In addition, my PhD project was funded through a competitive internal call at the University of Oulu, for which I independently designed my PhD research project and successfully secured funding from the Faculty of Technology and Natural Sciences.

RESEARCH SUPERVISION AND LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

- Identifying a gap and leading the development of a master's and PhD level course	2024-2025
- Leading project on global wolf morphology	2021-present
- Leading project on boardgame development and children opinion study	2020-present
- Leading project on Eurasian wolverine genetics	2020-2024
- Supervising a bachelor student in morphology work	2025
- Supervising 2 master students	2020

TEACHING

- Developing and teaching **Presentation tactics for science communication** course, receiving excellent student feedback 2024-2025
- Teaching 3D landmarking at the **Geometric morphometrics** Course, Copenhagen 2024
- Teaching Basics in **Bioinformatics**, University of Oulu, Finland 2020 – 2023

AWARDS AND HONOURS

- **PhD with distinction**, University of Oulu, Oulu, Finland, Date: 11.05.2026
- **Best conference poster 1st place** at the IX European Congress of Mammalogy, Patras, Greece 2025, awarded by the European Mammal Foundation. Date: 04.04.2025
- **Immediate reward** (“Välitön palkitseminen”) by University of Oulu for designing activities and acquiring funding, for a science communication and creation of board game, and hosting a workshop in the 2022 Science Day event in a highly successful manner. Date: 21.12.2022.

OTHER KEY ACADEMIC MERITS

- IUCN Canid Specialist Group (CSG), <https://www.canids.org/> 2026 – present
- Hosting a workshop on Futures Frequencies during Science Day at the University of Oulu 2022
- Organizing Kaamos Symposium, University of Oulu, chair of the organizing committee 2020

SCIENTIFIC AND SOCIETAL IMPACT

- **University of Oulu Science Day**, University of Oulu, Oulu, Finland – Presenting research poster on science communication: “From Science to Kids and back: The Lone Wolf Board Game” 2024
- **Researchers’ Night**, University of Oulu – Leading and organizing exhibition titled: “Living World from Different Perspectives” that showcased the research at the biology department 2023
- **Researchers’ Night**, University of Oulu – Presenting project “From Science to Kids and back: The Lone Wolf Board Game”, workshop for children 2022
- **Creating a board game** about wolves for science communication, making the materials openly available: <https://wildlifegenomics.wordpress.com/print-your-own-game/> 2020-2023

INVITED TALKS

- **Annual meeting of the Finnish Mammal Society**, in Zoom, 18.03.2026, talk on wolf morphology and science communication
- **Mossca** podcast (Spotify), February 2025, **Interview about creating a board game to improve perception of wolves in Finland**. <https://open.spotify.com/episode/0Dr2nzfSBS4ArGoi2ol0Ow>
- **Working Together: Addressing Polycrisis Through Interdisciplinary Research at the University of Oulu, Oulu**, 04.06.2025, panel discussion
- **Scientific Advisory Board (SAB) meeting**, 18.03.2025, University of Oulu - Presenting project “From Science to Kids and back: The Lone Wolf Board Game”
- **Collapse of the living seminar**, 15.03.2024, University of Oulu – Presenting project “From Science to Kids and back: The Lone Wolf Board Game”, talk and panel discussion

PRESENTING RESEARCH AT CONFERENCES

- **11th International Council for Archaeozoology AGPM meeting**, 14th – 17th October 2025, Copenhagen, Denmark – A flash talk and a poster with topic: Isolation, prey, and geography shape wolf skulls
- **9th European Congress of Mammalogy**, 31st March – 4th April 2025, Patras, Greece – A talk on Fennoscandian Wolf Morphology and a poster on Fostering Human-Wolf co-existence
- **5th Finnish Molecular Ecology Symposium**, 24th – 26th April 2024, Joensuu, Finland - Presenting research on Eurasian wolverine genetics
- **40th Riistapäivät (Finnish Wildlife Management and Research Conference)**, 23rd – 24th January 2024, Oulu - Presenting poster about Eurasian wolverine genetics
- **27^h Kaamos Symposium**, 31st November – 1st December 2023, University of Oulu, Oulu, Finland - Presenting research on Eurasian wolverine genetics
- **The 7th International Symposium “Dynamics of game animal populations in Northern Europe”**, 24th 28th September 2018, Karelian Research Institute, Petrozavodsk, Russia – Research on wolverines

SELECTED RESEARCH MEDIA COVERAGE

- **Maaseudun Tulevaisuus plus 16 other Finnish newspapers, and others from Netherlands, USA, Sweden, and Great Britain** shared on our research findings, 07-08.07.2026, Wolves around the world have evolved different skull shapes—humans are also shaping their evolution, <https://www.maaseuduntulevaisuus.fi/metsa/5e1ed12f-d1d0-4322-a914-6d9f6fca4e5f>
- **KESKISUOMALAINEN**, 25.06.2025, The shape of the wolf's head changed due to persecution <https://www.ksml.fi/uutissuomalainen/8632953>
- **YLE News** 20:30pm, 08.07.2025, <https://areena.yle.fi/1-72361945>; Interview about Fennoscandian Wolf Morphology, with story featured in online YLE blog 13.07.2025, <https://yle.fi/a/74-20170333>
- **KALEVA**, 22.05.2024, Students were allowed to howl with permission at Ylikiiming School – A wolf-themed board game developed at the University of Oulu teaches about the diversity of nature <https://www.kaleva.fi/oppilaat-saivat-ulvoa-luvan-kanssa-ylikiimingin-ko/8126841>
- **Maaseudun Tulevaisuus**, 29.10.2024 Researchers explore young people's opinions about large carnivores using a board game <https://www.maaseuduntulevaisuus.fi/metsa/b7a6b03f-fe60-4956-a119-127513f6596d>
- **KALEVA**, 30.10.2024, University of Oulu researchers invite schools to play the Lone Wolf board game <https://www.kaleva.fi/oulun-ylipiston-tutkijat-kutsuvat-kouluja-pelaama/11384181>